

the version of Office 2000 that you have installed. So, for your installation of Office 2000 premium, the {GUID} would be {00000409-78E1-11D2-B60F-006097C998E7}. Using regedit, navigate to the registry key mentioned and check the data value. If empty, add the value mentioned above.

Applications

+ No music

I am using the Windows Me operating system. Whenever I try to run Winamp, an error which says 'Winamp has caused an error in kernel32.dll. Winamp will close now' appears and I am unable to run the player. I uninstalled Winamp and reinstalled it but the error persists. Also, the MULTIMEDIA AND MMSYS.CPL file in the Control Panel is missing. Please suggest remedial measure.

Sukumar

Via e-mail

R There are two possibilities here: It could be because your sound card isn't properly installed, or that some of your system files are corrupt. To check whether your sound card is installed properly, check whether the device manager displays its name without any exclamation marks against it. To check for the second possibility, go to Control panel > Add/ Remove programs > Windows Setup and from the Accessories selection box, deselect the entire multimedia category and click on Apply. Restart the machine and go to the same menu and reselect the multimedia category. This will remove and reinstall the multimedia components, thereby repairing any corrupt or missing files.

Applications

+ No play, no fun

I have a 12x DVD drive on my machine (P-III 866 MHz processor, 20 GB HDD, 128 MB RAM). I have Windows Me installed. I have one movie DVD and four DVD software, all trial versions. When I run the DVD it plays back only for 5 minutes. If I delete this software I get the following message, 'You need DVD Decoder Software or DVD Decoder hardware'. So how do I run the DVD movie on my PC?

Nirav

Via e-mail

R Are you looking for a 'free' and 'good' DVD player? None exists! If you want a good DVD player, you'll have to pay for it, since the licensing fees that software companies have to pay for CSS/Dolby/DTS will mean that there is no way they can offer it

for free. There is one DVD player that offers no play-time restrictions, namely, VideoLAN (www.videolan.org).



VideoLAN: a free software DVD player

Windows and Applications

+ Of improper shut downs and space savers

I have a Pentium-III (550 MHz) with 64 MB RAM on an 810 chipset-based motherboard. While booting, I get an option to select Windows Me or Windows 2000 (Professional). I am facing two problems for over six months. I have tried all the menu options available along with registry editing in both OSes to an extent, but I have failed to resolve them.

Problem 1: In both OS (Win Me and 2000P), when I use the Shut Down option from the Start menu, both the OS perform an otherwise normal shutdown by saving settings but do not display the end message 'It is now safe to shutdown the computer'. In Me, the message gets displayed as a flicker for less than a second before the screen goes blank and I am able to power off. In 2000P, after saving the user settings, the blue screen is displayed after which the system restarts (instead of shutting down). At this point I normally power off. I have checked the msconfig.exe to check if the Fast Shutdown option was selected but this option wasn't there.

Problem 2: I have installed Pixelview

TV Tuner card along with its running and capture software on Windows Me. I have recorded some TV clips using the software but the only format created by it is .avi. The AVI files take up a lot of disk space because of which I am not in a position to transfer them to a CD. For example, there is a three-and-a-half minute song that is taking up almost 700 MB of space out of the total of 2 GB taken by these AVI files. Please suggest some software/utilities using which I can convert these files to MPEG or any other format and free up some space also.

Sarang Shahane

Via e-mail

R As regards your first problem, you don't have power management explicitly enabled in your BIOS or you disabled ATX soft power off because of which your OS is not able to soft power off. Windows Me issues a call but doesn't have a failure switch over to reboot if the call does not work. Window 2000 does issue an alternate reboot call if the shutdown call fails.

To test whether Power Management is correctly installed, go to the control panel and double-click on Power options. Then on the APM tab, click Enable Advanced Power management support.

Regarding your second problem, install Virtual Dub (www.virtualdub.org) and Divx 4.0 from Divx.com and use the combination to compress your AVI files to a compression far greater than MPEG.

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